

There is no part of our life that money does not touch. It affects our relationships, the way we go about every day activities of our lives, our ability to make our dreams a reality, in fact everything!! The fact that money does not buy happiness is a very true statement, but money does enable you to create more happiness in life if you know how to make good use of it. During my financial freedom journey, I have learnt a great deal about what money can do.

As someone said:

*"It's not the knife which kills; it's the intention of the person holding the knife that kills."*

A knife can solve so many of your complex problems in the kitchen if you know how to take care while using it and if you have the right intent to use it.

Likewise, money can do wonders if you know how to take care of your money and if you have the right intent. If you have some goals in life for which you wish to take out more time, money can definitely help you buy that time.

My career blasted off with a gold medal and a campus selection in Larsen & Toubro Limited (L&T) after passing my Engineering degree from Aligarh Muslim University. After having served the Electrical industry for almost 6 years, I made a push towards the IT industry. "This was the master move" I thought to myself. And it did turn out to be that, starting off from a small IT firm, I jumped jobs and saw my salary go up almost 10 times in the next 9 years. I even had the pleasure of working for some of the biggest Fortune 500 organizations like TCS and IBM.

Along with my professional life, my personal life was running on a parallel track and going equally well. God was very kind to us. By this time, I had two beautiful, adorable and charming daughters. My life seemed to be ideal -the successful story of a smart, modern, new generation IT professional.

But as may be the case with most of us (it is a separate fact that we may or may not agree), my wife and I were still not happy from within. We still had the fear of losing our jobs and our monthly pay cheques. We feared